It had been a tonic to walk in Reykjavik and see people smile and wave and call themselves supporters, but I was tired that season, feeling I'd already travelled over so much territory, so many big stories and so many changes that enhanced progress but threatened life and limb. I began to feel drained as the legislation dragged on. It was just a parliamentary ill-chance, like many others, but I felt it personally as a quiet condemnation to a life on the lam. In some very obvious way, I have been escaping from some dark pursuer since I was a child and my mother took us across country to escape from her stalker. In Iceland, you could barely tell the difference between night and day, which, I realised, had been my regular position since I was thirteen. I was still up all night with a computer, and escaping by day to some new set of possibilities. But my battery goes low shortly before it magically shows itself fully charged.

A video had been sent to our drop-box. It showed grainy images of some men walking down a street in Iraq. Two of them are journalists. In a minute they will all be dead, shot to pieces from a US helicopter gunship. I watched it again and again, knowing we were about to enter into the full public glare of something new.